

have attempted to address these fundamental issues, security problems persist. Vulnerabilities (such as SMS spoofing) have been found in many current protocols that continue to allow the possibility of eavesdropping or cloning.

Viruses and other malicious code can spread through PDAs and smartphones. First, the handset's functioning may get impaired by the virus. Moreover, if an infected mobile device is used to upload data onto a corporate network, that may be adversely affected. The danger from mobile viruses may grow as the use of PDAs and smart phones proliferates. And virus writers will certainly not spare the mobile devices and operating systems market.



A virus on cell phone can render it useless

In reference to simple SMS spoofing, consider this scenario: a cyber criminal could send you a message from your friend's cell - a fake message that can fool the receiver into thinking it is from the actual sender. For instance, if someone received a message from his or her spouse that said, "Withdraw Rs 10,000 immediately and deposit into my account", he or she would first try to call the spouse. If the spouse is not reachable, the person might end up actually doing what the SMS said. Such scams have actually occurred. Of course, such scenarios are contingent on a cell phone being stolen or left unattended.

In India, SMS Spoofing of the real kind - wherein the spoofer doesn't even have access to the phone the SMS seems to be coming from - was tested by the Pune-based Asian School of Cyber Laws, which used SMS Spoofing to help investigation and law enforcement agencies trap terrorists and narcotics dealers.

The significant growth of SMS as form of communication has